

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 551

By Hakeem

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Moccasin Bend Mental Health Institute's Bleyzer Program.

WHEREAS, it is the privilege of this General Assembly to recognize those premier medical facilities and their programs that compassionately and capably serve the citizens of this State; and

WHEREAS, one such facility is Moccasin Bend Mental Health Institute (MBMHI) of Chattanooga, a psychiatric hospital and one of four Regional Mental Health Institutes operated by the Department of Mental Health and Substance Abuse Services, which serves fifty-two counties in East Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, MBMHI's Bleyzer Program was recently recognized by The Rutgers Institute for Inpatient Psychiatric Rehabilitation, garnering the first annual IIPR Award, which recognizes Bleyzer as an innovative program that embodies the goals, values, and principles of psychiatric rehabilitation in adult inpatient settings; and

WHEREAS, established in 2020, the Bleyzer Program was designed to serve patients who have been in the clinical inpatient setting for an extended period of time, helping to prepare them for discharge and community reintegration; and

WHEREAS, using a "community living" approach, the program is designed to help patients develop coping skills to manage their mental illness; and

WHEREAS, patients gain or refine independent living skills, confidence, and self-esteem, all while working toward individual goals and obtaining the tools needed to function within their community upon discharge; patients work together to complete chores and plan and prepare meals, including shopping in the community; and

WHEREAS, the express mission of the program is to "Blaze new trails back into the community through facilitation and practice of vocation, support, and knowledge of recovery"; and

WHEREAS, Bleyzer has seen great success with the thirty-six patients who have graduated from the program; only three of the patients returned to the program, for medication adjustment or need for new placement, and the length of stay was less than one month; and

WHEREAS, the Bleyzer Program benefits from the knowledge, care, and dedication of staff members John Gonzales, Arlisa Good, Spring Hughes, and Anthony Johnson; and

WHEREAS, Moccasin Bend Mental Health Institute's Bleyzer Program serves the Eastern Grand Division with compassionate care and has been vital to the well-being of its citizens; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Moccasin Bend Mental Health Institute's Bleyzer Program for its compassionate, devoted service to the people of East Tennessee, extending our best wishes for much continued success in the future.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.